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A Scientist in Hollywood:

THE GENESIS OF *INTERSTELLAR*

Lynda Obst, My Hollywood Partner

The seed for *Interstellar* was a failed romance that warped into a creative friendship and partnership.

In September 1980, my friend Carl Sagan phoned me. He knew I was a single father, raising a teenaged daughter (or trying to do so; I wasn't very good at it), and living a Southern California single's life (I was only a bit better at that), while pursuing a theoretical physics career (at *that* I was a lot better).

Carl called to propose a blind date. A date with Lynda Obst to attend the world premier of Carl's forthcoming television series, *Cosmos*.

Lynda, a brilliant and beautiful counterculture-and-science editor for the *New York Times Magazine*, was recently transplanted to Los Angeles. She had been dragged there kicking and screaming by her husband, which contributed to their separation. Making the best of a